



Creatures great and small

The Egyptians believed in many different gods and goddesses, some of which took the form of animals. They mummified animals as offerings to these gods. When mummified, the creatures made some odd shapes.



Mummified crocodile



Mummified cow



Mummified cat



The lid of the coffin is decorated with symbols of the gods. These are the wings of the sky goddess, Nut.

This coffin is made of wood. Early ones were made of clay or woven out of reeds like a basket.



The hieroglyphs were spells to help the priestess on her journey to the next life.

Brightly colored figures and symbols are painted on the inside of the coffin.

This mummy case may have been one of a nest of coffins, each fitting inside the next like a set of Russian dolls.

All wrapped up

All mummies were wrapped up tightly in lots of material. As much as 4,000 sq feet (375 sq meters) of linen might be needed to wrap up a single mummy.

